

Private Bank & Wealth Management

First: the firm split up clearly, so the revenue picture finally makes sense. Then everything about the wealth business — how it is structured, how it earns, who it targets, where it ranks, what it has just won and lost, and why a client picks Barclays over UBS, Coutts or an independent.

£1,380m

FY2025 income

26.3%

RoTE — best in
the group

£227.6bn

client assets &
liabilities

£55.8bn

AUM, June 2026

~1,300

private bank
staff

PART ONE

The firm, split up — properly this time

Barclays has exactly five operating divisions. Not business areas, not brands — five, each with its own published income, profit and returns. Here they are drawn to scale.

The whole firm, drawn to scale

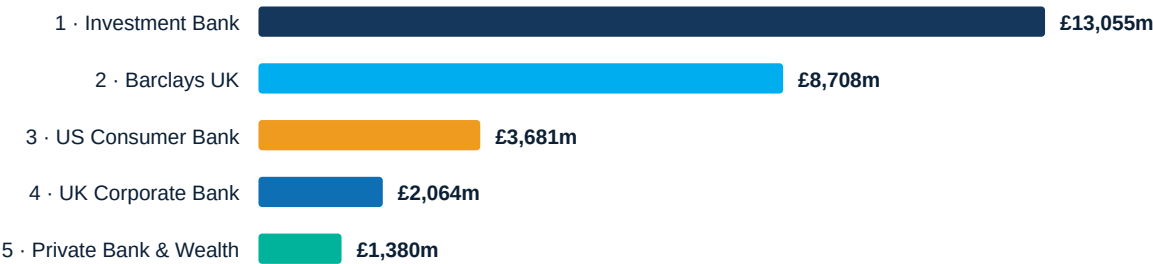
Every box is one division. Box AREA = share of the £29.1bn of FY2025 income. This is the answer to "which division is biggest".



That single picture answers the question. **The Investment Bank is the biggest revenue division by a wide margin** — £13.1bn, more than the other four combined would need Barclays UK's help to match. Barclays UK is a clear second at £8.7bn. Then there is a steep drop to the US Consumer Bank, the UK Corporate Bank, and finally the Private Bank & Wealth Management at £1,380m.

Ranked by income — the direct answer

FY2025 total income by division. Head Office (£252m) is a central cost centre, not a business, and is excluded.



The same thing as a table, with running totals — so you can see how concentrated the income is.

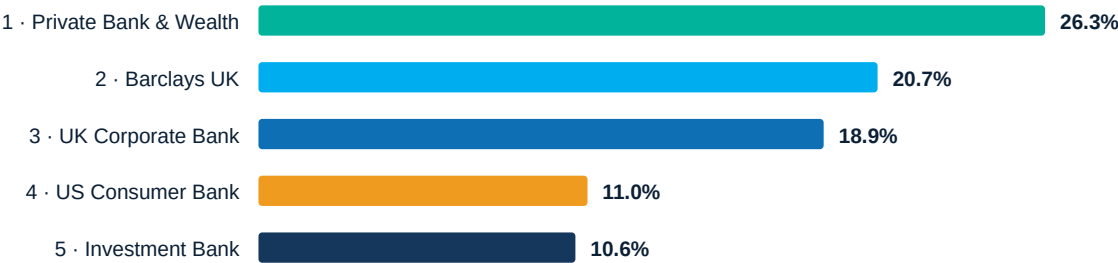
Division	FY2025 income	Share	Running total	What it sells, in one line
Investment Bank	£13,055m	45.2%	45.2%	Trading, advice and capital-raising for institutions and big companies
Barclays UK	£8,708m	30.1%	75.3%	The high street — accounts, mortgages, Barclaycard, Tesco Bank
US Consumer Bank	£3,681m	12.7%	88.0%	American credit cards issued under partner brands
UK Corporate Bank	£2,064m	7.1%	95.2%	Banking for British SMEs and mid-caps
Private Bank & Wealth	£1,380m	4.8%	100%	Investing, planning and lending for wealthy individuals and families
Five divisions	£28,888m	100%	—	Plus £252m of Head Office income; Group total £29,140m

NOW THE TWIST — AND IT IS THE REASON THIS REPORT EXISTS

Rank the same five divisions by **return on the capital they use** instead of by revenue, and the order almost exactly reverses. The division that earns the least money is the one that earns the most *per pound of shareholder capital risked*.

Ranked by return on capital — the ranking flips

FY2025 RoTE. The smallest division by income is the most profitable per pound of shareholder capital in the entire group.



Private Bank & Wealth Management produced 4.8% of Barclays' income and did it on 2.2% of the bank's risk-weighted assets — £8.0bn out of £356.8bn. That is why its RoTE is 26.3% while the Investment Bank, five times its size, managed 10.6%. Small division, best economics. Everything in the rest of this report follows from that fact.

Where the wealth business physically sits in the group

One structural detail worth knowing, because it is unusual and it comes up: Barclays is legally split by the UK ring-fence into **Barclays Bank UK PLC** (retail, protected) and **Barclays Bank PLC** (international, markets). Four of the five divisions sit cleanly on one side or the other.

Private Bank & Wealth Management is the exception — it straddles the fence. The UK wealth business sits inside the ring-fence; the international private bank, booked in Switzerland, Monaco, the Crown Dependencies and soon Singapore, sits outside it. That is not a quirk of reporting: it means the division operates under two regulatory regimes at once, which is part of why it can serve both a Premier customer in Leeds and a cross-border family office in Geneva.

PART TWO

How the wealth division splits up

"Private Bank & Wealth Management" is one reporting line covering several quite different businesses. Here is what is actually inside it.

The two halves

Barclays runs the division as **PBWM UK** and **PBWM International**, and the split is roughly even: **about half of income is generated in the UK and about half internationally**. That balance is unusual — most UK wealth managers are overwhelmingly domestic, and most Swiss private banks have no retail funnel at all.

PBWM UK

Domestic wealth, sitting inside the ring-fenced bank. Covers Premier Wealth Management, Direct Investing (the platform formerly called Smart Investor), UK private banking, and the Wealth Management & Investments business transferred in from Barclays UK in 2024.

Fed directly by ~20 million Barclays UK customers. This is the volume engine.

PBWM International

Booked outside the ring-fence, through centres in Switzerland, Monaco, the Crown Dependencies and — being built out during 2026 — Singapore. Dubai and Singapore have operated as sales offices, with Singapore gaining full booking capability.

Private Banking International serves clients with £5m+ of investable assets. Higher minimums, more complex needs, cross-border structuring. This is the margin engine.

The client ladder — the single best thing about this business

Barclays does not have one wealth product. It has a staircase, and a client can be moved up it as their wealth grows without ever leaving the bank. Very few competitors own more than two or three of these rungs.

The wealth ladder — every rung is a Barclays product

Read bottom to top. No competitor owns this many rungs, and that is the whole commercial argument.



WHY THE LADDER IS THE COMMERCIAL ARGUMENT

Client acquisition is the dominant cost in wealth management. An independent firm must buy or win every single client from cold. Barclays does not: it already banks the person, already sees their salary land, already knows when they sell their company, and can simply invite them up a rung. The GoHenry acquisition in June 2026 — roughly **£180m for a money app used by about 500,000 UK children** — makes the logic almost comically explicit. Barclays is now attempting to hold a relationship from a child's first debit card through to a family's estate plan.

The thresholds, precisely

Entry points into each tier. Know these — they are the most concrete facts about the business and almost nobody at an insight day has them.

Tier	You qualify with	What you get
Premier Banking	£75,000 gross annual income or £100,000 in savings and eligible investments	Relationship banking, preferential products. The recruiting ground for everything above.
Premier Wealth Management LAUNCHED APRIL 2026	£150,000 to invest	A dedicated expert, in-depth financial review with no upfront fee — you pay ongoing fees only if you proceed with advice.
Direct Investing (formerly Smart Investor)	No minimum	Self-directed ISAs and investment accounts. Barclays has removed the monthly customer/custody fee on these.
Private Bank — UK	Around £3m investable (sources vary by tier and relationship)	A named private banker, discretionary and advisory portfolios, bespoke secured lending, trusts, estate and succession planning.
Private Banking — International	£5m+ investable	Cross-border booking, multi-jurisdiction structuring, access to private markets and institutional products.

Typical ongoing management fees run in the region of **0.50%–1.45%** of assets a year, depending on service level and mandate.

PART THREE

How wealth management actually makes money

This is the core mechanism, and it is genuinely different from every other division in Barclays.

How the wealth division earns its £1,380m

FY2025. The split matters: interest income is rate-driven and shrinking in importance; fee income is what the strategy is chasing.

INTEREST — 58% OF INCOME

£799m

Wealthy clients hold a lot of cash. The division held £72.0bn of deposits against just £14.7bn of lending — a five-to-one surplus it passes to the wider group.

Lending is secured against portfolios and property, structured case by case. Credit losses are close to zero: FY2025 booked an £8m impairment RELEASE.

Rate-sensitive, so it falls as rates fall.

FEES — 42% OF INCOME

£581m

Charged as a percentage of invested assets, roughly 0.50%–1.45% a year, billed whether markets rise or fall.

Three kinds (H1 2024 disclosure, £234m total):

- Advisory and management fees — £156m
- Brokerage and execution — £62m
- Transactional banking fees — £16m

Recurring, capital-light, and what investors pay up for.

The thing most people get wrong

Ask a student how a private bank makes money and they will say "fees on assets". That is only **42%** of it. In FY2025 the division earned £1,380m of income, of which **£581m was net fee, commission and other income** — leaving roughly **£799m of net interest income**.

Wealthy clients hold a great deal of cash. The division held **£72.0bn of customer deposits against only £14.7bn of lending**. That surplus is passed to the wider group and earns a spread. It is the same structural-hedge dynamic that drives Barclays UK — which is why this division's returns benefited enormously from rates rising, and why management is now working hard to grow the fee half before that tailwind fades.

Why the returns are so good — the capital point

The division earns 26.3% on tangible equity because of what it *doesn't* do:

- **It barely uses capital.** £8.0bn of RWAs — 2.2% of the group's total — for 4.8% of the group's income. Managing someone's portfolio consumes almost no regulatory capital; underwriting a bond does.
- **It barely loses money on credit.** Lending is secured against liquid portfolios and property and structured case by case. FY2025 recorded an **£8m impairment release** — the division gave money *back*. Compare the US Consumer Bank's £1,521m of impairment charges.
- **Its income is recurring.** Management fees are billed on assets whether markets rise or fall, which is exactly the "all-weather" income Barclays' management keeps talking about.

The trade-off is the cost line. At a **73% cost:income ratio** this is the least efficient division in Barclays, because the product is expensive, experienced people. It is a high-return, low-capital, high-cost business. Understanding that triangle is understanding the whole thing.

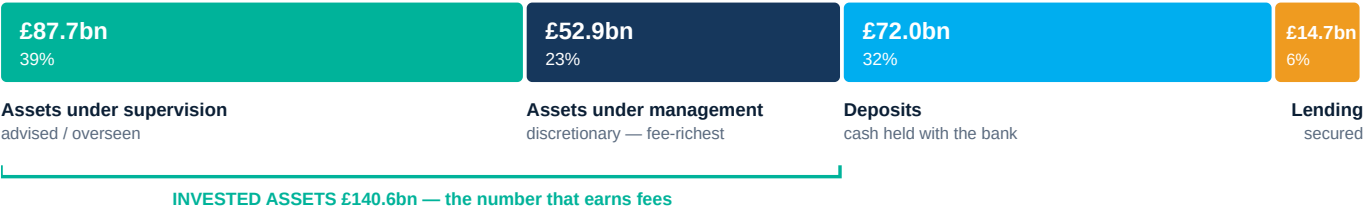
The three asset numbers — and why they are not interchangeable

Barclays quotes three different figures. Journalists mix them up constantly. Getting them right is a cheap way to sound like you have read the accounts.

Three different asset numbers, and why people confuse them

Barclays quotes AUM, assets under supervision and client assets & liabilities. They mean different things and only one of them is the fee engine. FY2025 figures; components sum to £227.3bn against £227.6bn reported.

CLIENT ASSETS & LIABILITIES · £227.6bn as reported



What each number means and why it matters.

Measure	FY2025	What it is
Assets under management (AUM)	£52.9bn (£55.8bn at Jun 2026)	Money Barclays manages on a <i>discretionary</i> basis — it makes the investment decisions. The highest-fee, stickiest category. This is the number to watch.
Assets under supervision (AUS)	£87.7bn (£86.7bn at Jun 2026)	Assets Barclays advises on or oversees but does not manage discretionarily. Lower fee per pound.
Invested assets	£140.6bn	AUM + AUS. The pool that generates fee income.
Client assets & liabilities (CA&L)	£227.6bn (from £208.9bn)	The widest measure: invested assets <i>plus</i> deposits <i>plus</i> lending. The total client footprint — and the number Barclays prefers to quote, because it is the biggest.
Net new AUM	£3.3bn FY2025 £1.8bn in H1 2026	New money won, net of money lost, stripping out market movement. The single cleanest measure of whether the business is actually winning.

THE NUANCE THAT SEPARATES YOU FROM THE ROOM

AUM rose from £52.9bn to £55.8bn in H1 2026 — but net new AUM was only £1.8bn of that, and Q2's 15% year-on-year AUM growth was helped by **favourable market valuations**. Rising markets flatter every wealth manager's headline. If you want to know whether Barclays is winning clients rather than riding an index, you look at net new AUM — and at £1.8bn it was slightly *below* the same period in 2025.

PART FOUR

The numbers, read honestly

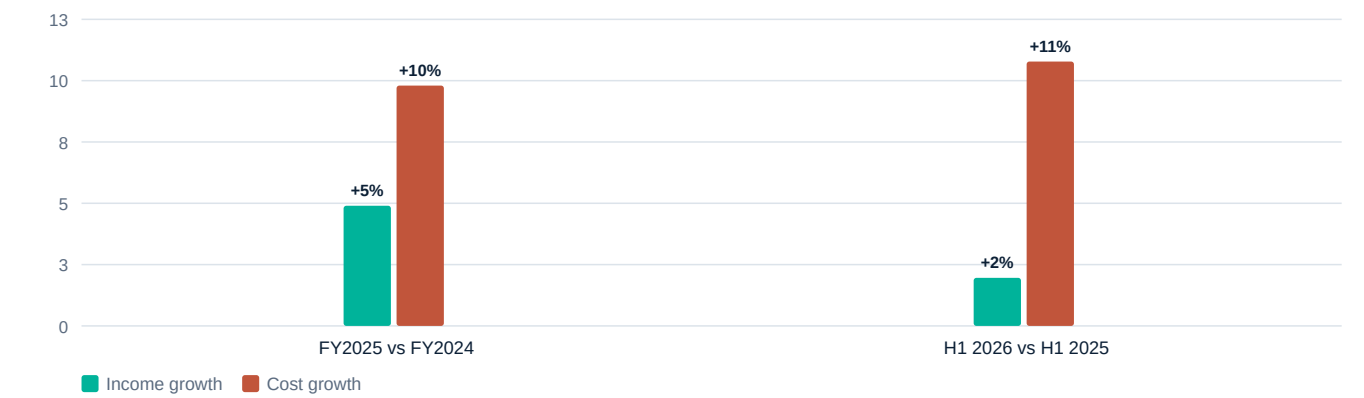
The division is the best-returning in Barclays and its profit is currently falling. Both are true, and the reason is the most interesting thing about it right now.

Barclays Private Bank & Wealth Management — the full picture (£m unless stated).

Measure	FY2024	FY2025	H1 2025	H1 2026
Total income	1,309	1,380	697	713
of which net fee, commission & other	543	581	—	—
Operating expenses	920	1,013	474	524
Credit impairment	6	(8)	(11)	3
Profit before tax	383	375	234	186
Attributable profit	288	291	185	148
RoTE	28.1%	26.3%	33.2%	26.1%
Cost:income ratio	70%	73%	68%	73%
Risk weighted assets (£bn)	7.9	8.0	7.9	8.0
Customer deposits (£bn)	69.5	72.0	—	—
Loans & advances (£bn)	14.5	14.7	—	—
Assets under management (£bn)	47.7	52.9	—	55.8
Net new AUM (£bn)	3.7	3.3	~2.0	1.8
Client assets & liabilities (£bn)	208.9	227.6	—	—

The honest picture: costs are growing faster than income

Year-on-year percentage change. This is deliberate — Barclays is spending ahead of the revenue — but it is why profit fell.



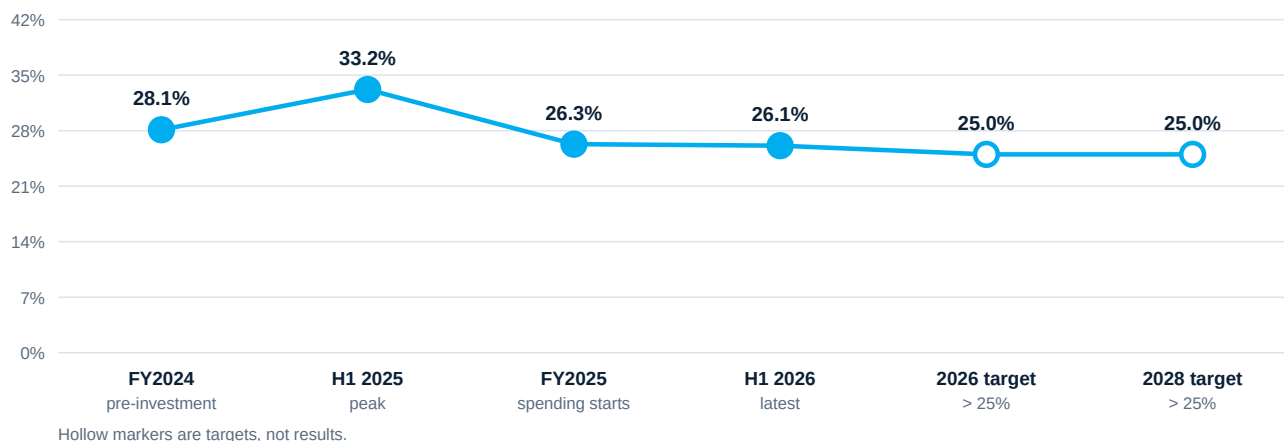
What is actually happening

In H1 2026 income grew **2%** to £713m while operating expenses grew **11%** to £524m. Attributable profit fell **20%** to £148m, the cost:income ratio widened from 68% to 73%, and RoTE fell from 33.2% to 26.1%. Barclays' own explanation is "investment to support business growth strategy and inflationary headwinds", partly offset by efficiency savings.

Two other things moved: credit impairment swung from an £11m release in H1 2025 to a £3m charge — a swing of £14m on its own — and the prior-year comparison was unusually strong.

Return on tangible equity — still comfortably above target

The fall from 33.2% is the cost of the growth plan, not a deterioration in the business. The division is still the best-returning in Barclays.



HOW TO TALK ABOUT THIS — THE MATURE READING

A naive candidate sees profit down 20% and calls it a problem. A better reading: Barclays is **deliberately spending ahead of revenue** because it has decided this is the division worth investing in. The spending is specific and disclosed — **up to 100 new wealth managers** hired into the cost base, and **annual technology spend for wealth up more than 75%** on its 2021–22 level.

Advisers are a lagging cost and a leading indicator: you pay them for eighteen months before they bring in the assets. So the shape you would expect — costs up first, income later — is exactly the shape in the accounts. And even mid-investment the division is delivering **26.1% RoTE against a target of "greater than 25%"**, and remains the highest-returning business in Barclays. That is the answer, and it shows you can read an income statement in context rather than in isolation.

PART FIVE

Where it ranks

Be accurate about this. Barclays is a serious wealth manager and it is not a global giant, and pretending otherwise is the fastest way to lose credibility.

The global picture

Global wealth managers by scale. Read the "measure" column carefully — these are not like-for-like, and conflating them is the most common error made about this industry.

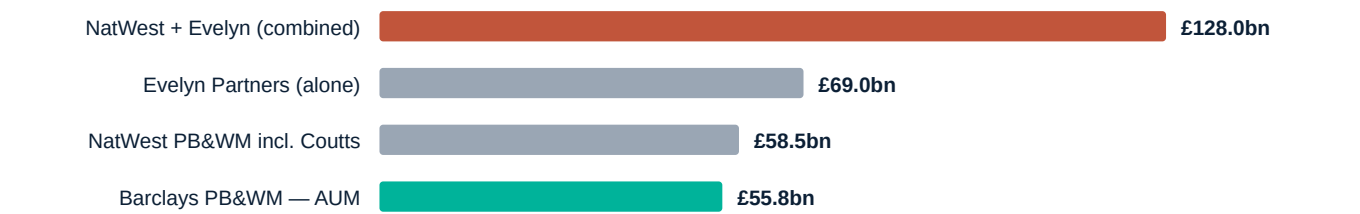
Firm	Scale	Measure	As at
Morgan Stanley Wealth Management	\$7.35trn	Total client assets	Mar 2026
UBS (group)	\$7.3trn	Invested assets, group-wide	Q2 2026
Julius Baer	CHF 547bn	Assets under management	Jun 2026
HSBC Global Private Banking	\$395bn	Private banking assets	Dec 2024
NatWest + Evelyn Partners	£128bn	Combined AUM, pro-forma	Deal agreed Feb 2026
Barclays PB&WM	£140.6bn invested assets £55.8bn AUM	Invested assets / AUM	FY2025 / Jun 2026

The honest verdict: Barclays is not in the same weight class as UBS or Morgan Stanley and is not trying to be. It is comparable to Julius Baer and HSBC's private bank in ambition but smaller in managed assets, and it is genuinely in the front rank in the UK. Its international footprint — Switzerland, Monaco, the Crown Dependencies, India, the Gulf and now Singapore — is real and long-established, but it is a focused network rather than a global one.

The UK picture — and the event that just reshaped it

The UK league table — and what NatWest just did to it

Assets under management, most recent disclosure. NatWest agreed to buy Evelyn Partners for £2.7bn in February 2026, beating Barclays in the auction. On AUM alone that leapfrogs Barclays overnight.



THE MOST IMPORTANT THING THAT HAS HAPPENED IN UK WEALTH THIS YEAR

In February 2026 **NatWest agreed to buy Evelyn Partners for £2.7bn**, taking its private banking and wealth AUM from around £59bn to a combined **£128bn**. **Barclays bid for Evelyn and lost**. The auction, run by Evercore, also drew RBC and several private equity firms.

This matters for three reasons. First, it tells you Barclays' strategic conviction is real — it was willing to spend billions on the mass-affluent segment. Second, it tells you Barclays is now committed to **organic growth by necessity as much as by choice**: the biggest available UK acquisition has gone. Third, it defines the competitive question for the next three years — can Barclays' internal referral engine win clients faster than NatWest can integrate a £69bn acquisition?

If you say one current thing about this division on 14 September, say this.

PART SIX

The clients, and why these ones

Barclays has been unusually explicit about who it is chasing. The target is not, primarily, the ultra-rich.

The gap Barclays is aiming at

Sasha Wiggins, chief executive of the division, frames the opportunity in one number: “The UK is a large market with client investable assets totalling some 3.5 trillion pounds.” Against that, Barclays' own £140.6bn of invested assets is about 4% — which is the point. There is enormous room to grow inside a market Barclays already banks.

~4 million Barclays UK customers with £250k–£3m investable — the core target	£3.5trn total UK client investable assets	£250k–£3m the "mass affluent" band the whole plan is built around	£5m+ threshold for Private Banking International
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Read that first number again. Roughly four million people who already bank with Barclays have between £250,000 and £3m to invest. Barclays does not need to find them, market to them, or buy them — it already has their salary, their mortgage and their app. It simply needs to convert them. That is the single most important sentence in this report, and it is why Premier Wealth Management was launched in April 2026 with **no upfront fee** and why custody fees on Direct Investing were scrapped: remove every possible reason to say no.

Why this segment and not the ultra-wealthy

Segment	Why Barclays wants them	The catch
Mass affluent £250k–£3m	Barclays already owns the relationship, so acquisition cost is near zero. Huge in number. Advice can be standardised and delivered digitally, so margins improve with scale.	Fee per client is small; it only works at volume, which is exactly why technology spend is up more than 75%.
UK high-net-worth ~£3m+	Full private banking economics — discretionary mandates, secured lending, trusts. Often business owners already banked by the UK Corporate Bank.	Competitive and service-intensive. Coutts, UBS and independents fight hard for these clients.
International / cross-border £5m+	Highest fees and most complex needs. Barclays' Swiss, Monaco, Crown Dependency and Singapore booking centres are a genuine barrier to entry that took decades to build.	Heavy regulatory and compliance burden across multiple jurisdictions.
Entrepreneurs at exit	The crown jewel. When a founder sells a company — often advised by Barclays' own investment bank — a large sum of cash appears, and Barclays is already in the room.	Timing-dependent and relationship-driven; you cannot manufacture a liquidity event.

Where in the world

Barclays named its growth hubs explicitly: **London, Geneva, Dubai and India**, plus **Singapore**, where a full booking centre is being built during 2026 — Werner Schlossmacher was appointed COO for Barclays Private Bank Asia, based

in Singapore, reporting to Leo Müller, the division's COO. Barclays has had a presence across Asia since 1864 and has provided investment services in India since 1990.

AND WHERE IT HAS EXPLICITLY RULED OUT

The United States. Barclays has publicly ruled out re-entering US wealth management on grounds of cost and competition — a striking decision for a bank with a bulge-bracket Wall Street investment bank and a large American card business. It is also a decision with history behind it: Barclays **sold its US Wealth & Investment Management business to Stifel in December 2015**, roughly 180 advisers and about \$56bn of client assets. UBS, by contrast, is pushing hard into US mass-affluent wealth. The two firms have diverged deliberately, and being able to name that divergence is a genuinely sophisticated observation.

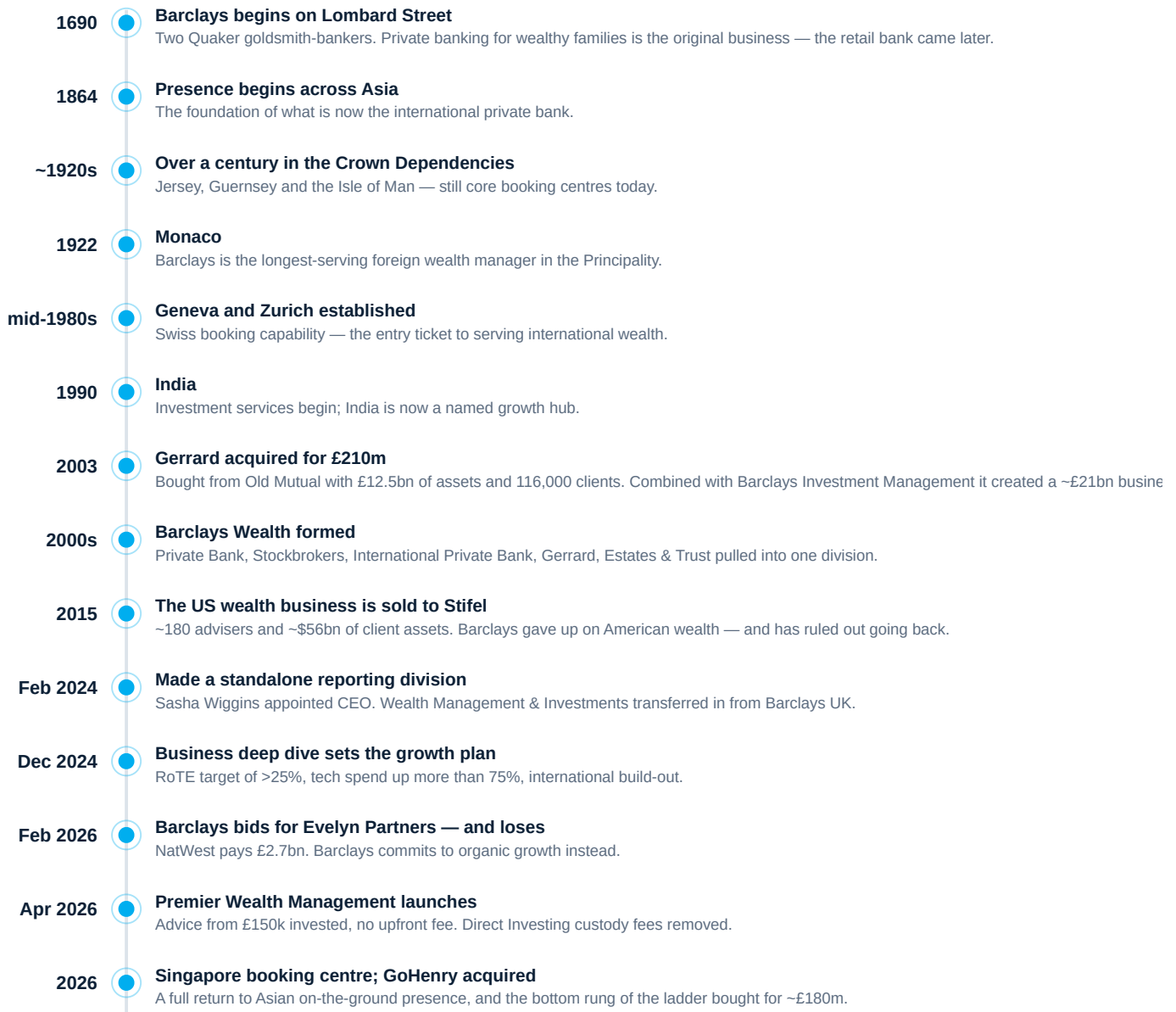
PART SEVEN

How long they have been doing this

You asked how long they have been around. In wealth management, longevity is not sentiment — it is licences, booking centres and trust businesses that competitors cannot replicate quickly.

Barclays has been doing this for 335 years

Longevity is not just heritage here — booking centres, trust licences and cross-border permissions take decades to build and are a genuine barrier to entry.



WHY THE HISTORY IS A COMMERCIAL MOAT, NOT A BROCHURE LINE

To serve an international private client you need a booking centre in the right jurisdiction, a trust and fiduciary licence, cross-border marketing permissions, and a regulator who trusts you. Barclays has been **over a century in the Crown Dependencies**, is the **longest-serving foreign wealth manager in Monaco**, established **Geneva and Zurich in the mid-1980s**, and has run investment services in **India since 1990**. A well-funded new entrant cannot buy that in five years — which is precisely why NatWest had to spend £2.7bn to buy scale rather than build it.

The 2003 deal that made the modern business

The most important single transaction in this division's history is one almost nobody mentions. In **December 2003 Barclays bought the Gerrard group from Old Mutual for £210m**. Gerrard came with **£12.5bn under management and 116,000 clients**, and a lineage traceable to at least 1870. Combined with Barclays Investment Management it created a business running more than **£21bn** in discretionary and advisory portfolios — at the time **the UK's largest adviser to wealthy investors**.

What Barclays specifically did: it bought a distribution network and a client book, not an investment process. Gerrard's value was 116,000 existing relationships and the advisers who held them. Barclays then folded Gerrard together with Barclays Private Bank, Barclays Stockbrokers, the International Private Bank and the Estates & Trust business to create Barclays Wealth. Every rung of today's ladder above Premier traces to that consolidation. It is also the template Barclays tried to repeat with Evelyn Partners in 2026 — buy the client book, plug it into the existing platform — and this time it was outbid.

PART EIGHT

News, deals, wins and losses

You asked for success stories, deals and closures. Here is everything material in the last eighteen months, with what each one actually tells you.

WON — Premier Wealth Management launched, April 2026

Advice and financial planning for Barclays Premier customers with **£150,000+ to invest**. Begins with a no-obligation in-depth financial review carrying **no upfront fee**; clients pay ongoing fees only if they proceed.

What it tells you: this is the mass-affluent conversion engine going live. CEO C.S. Venkatakrishnan described the strategy as a play to “own the entirety of the customer”. Removing the upfront fee removes the last friction between four million existing customers and an advice relationship.

WON — Direct Investing custody fees abolished

Barclays removed the monthly customer fee on Investment ISAs and Investment Accounts held with Direct Investing (renamed from Smart Investor).

What it tells you: deliberate margin sacrifice to buy scale and volume at the bottom of the ladder, betting those clients climb it later. It is also a direct response to zero-fee digital platforms.

LOST — the Evelyn Partners auction, February 2026

Barclays bid for Evelyn Partners (£69bn AUM, £250k minimum for discretionary management). **NatWest won at £2.7bn**, completing summer 2026, taking its combined wealth AUM to about £128bn. RBC and several private equity firms also participated in the Evercore-run process.

What it tells you: the single most important competitive fact in UK wealth right now. Barclays wanted to buy scale in exactly the segment it is targeting, was willing to pay billions, and was beaten. Organic execution is now the only route.

WON — GoHenry acquired, June 2026

Roughly **£180m** for GoHenry's UK business, brand and app — a money-management platform for 6–18 year-olds with more than **500,000 UK children** (about 2.3 million globally). Completing Q4 2026, pending regulatory approval. GoHenry will keep running as its own brand rather than being absorbed.

What it tells you: lifecycle banking taken to its logical extreme. Win the parent, win the child, hold the relationship from a first debit card to a family estate plan.

BUILDING — Singapore booking centre, 2026

A full return to on-the-ground private banking in Singapore, upgrading it from a sales office to a booking centre. Werner Schlossmacher appointed COO for Barclays Private Bank Asia, based in Singapore, reporting to Leo Müller.

What it tells you: Asia is where new wealth is being created fastest. A booking centre — not just a sales office — means assets can be held locally, which is what serious Asian and Middle Eastern clients require.

BUILDING — 100 wealth managers, tech spend up 75%+

Up to **100 new advisers** — relationship managers and operational staff — embedded in FY2026 cost guidance. Annual technology spend for wealth up **more than 75%** on its 2021–22 level. Hubs: London, Geneva, Dubai, India.

What it tells you: the division is actively hiring, which is directly relevant to you. It also explains the 11% cost growth in H1 2026.

CLOSED — US Wealth & Investment Management sold to Stifel, 2015

Completed 4 December 2015: approximately **180 financial advisers and \$56bn of client assets** transferred to Stifel Financial.

What it tells you: Barclays has failed at American wealth before and has explicitly ruled out returning on cost and competition grounds. This is the honest counterweight to the growth story, and mentioning it shows you have looked past the good news.

CONTEXT — the transfer that created today's division

In 2024 Barclays moved Wealth Management & Investments out of Barclays UK and into the private bank, creating the five-division structure and making PB&WM a standalone reported business under Sasha Wiggins from February 2024. Private bank income rose 17% to £1.2bn that year, with client assets and liabilities reaching nearly £180bn.

What it tells you: the division exists in its current form only because Barclays decided wealth deserved its own scoreboard. It is a young reporting line with old roots.

Why a client picks Barclays over anyone else

This is your question — what is it in the business model? The answer is not service quality or investment performance, because every competitor claims both.

The four genuine structural advantages

- 1. **The referral engine no independent can replicate.** Barclays does not have to find wealthy clients. It banks around 20 million UK customers and can see, in its own data, who has just received a large sum, whose income has jumped, whose business account just recorded a sale. Roughly four million existing customers sit in the £250k–£3m target band. An Evelyn Partners or a Rathbones must win every single client from a standing start; Barclays sends an invitation up its own ladder. *This is the whole argument, and everything else is secondary.*
- 2. **The investment bank connection.** When Barclays' investment bank advises a founder on selling their company, the private bank is present at the moment the cash lands. Coutts, Julius Baer and every UK independent lack a bulge-bracket M&A franchise. UBS has one — which is precisely why UBS is the most credible comparison.
- 3. **Balance sheet.** Barclays can lend meaningfully against a portfolio, a property, or an unlisted holding, structured case by case, funded by a £1.7trn bank. A pure wealth manager cannot lend at all, and this matters enormously to entrepreneurs who are asset-rich and cash-poor. It is also why the division's lending carries almost no credit losses.
- 4. **Cross-border booking that took a century to build.** Switzerland, Monaco, the Crown Dependencies, India, the Gulf, and Singapore from 2026. For a family with money and members in three countries, that is not a nice-to-have — it is the entire requirement, and most UK competitors simply cannot serve it.

Head to head — what each competitor has that Barclays does not, and vice versa.

Competitor	Their advantage over Barclays	Barclays' advantage over them
UBS	Vastly larger — \$7.3trn of invested assets. The definitive global brand in private banking, with unmatched Swiss heritage and reach.	Barclays owns a UK high-street funnel UBS has nothing like. UBS is chasing US mass-affluent; Barclays already owns four million British ones.
Coutts (NatWest)	Iconic British private-banking brand, and — post-Evelyn — a larger UK AUM base at ~£128bn combined.	Barclays has genuine international booking centres and a bulge-bracket investment bank. Coutts is overwhelmingly domestic. NatWest must now integrate a £69bn acquisition, which takes years.
HSBC Global Private Banking	\$395bn of private banking assets and far deeper Asian roots.	Barclays is stronger in the UK domestic funnel; HSBC's UK retail-to-wealth pipeline is smaller relative to its ambitions.
Julius Baer	CHF 547bn AUM, pure-play focus, no distractions, deep Swiss credibility.	No retail bank, no lending balance sheet of Barclays' size, no investment bank. Every client must be won from cold.
Evelyn Partners / Rathbones / Quilter / SJP	Independence — no conflict with a parent bank — and often lower minimums with deep financial-planning expertise.	No cheap client acquisition, no meaningful lending, no cross-border booking, no capital strength. This is the gap Barclays is exploiting with Premier Wealth Management.

THE HONEST WEAKNESSES — SAY THESE TOO

Scale. £55.8bn of AUM is a fraction of UBS or Morgan Stanley, and NatWest has just leapfrogged Barclays on UK AUM by acquisition.

Cost. A 73% cost:income ratio is the worst in Barclays, and costs are currently growing five times faster than income.

The conflict question. Independents will always argue that a bank-owned wealth manager is conflicted — pushing in-house product and using wealth as a funnel for the rest of the bank. Barclays' answer is that integration is a feature, not a bug; the client gets lending, banking and advice in one place. Both arguments are legitimate.

Rate dependency. 58% of income is net interest income. As rates fall that half comes under pressure, and the fee half has to grow fast enough to cover it.

PART TEN

Why you would want to work here

The roles, what the work actually is, and the honest case for and against — given you have decided this is the side of the business you care about.

What the jobs actually are

The main career tracks inside Private Bank & Wealth Management.

Role	What you actually do	Suits you if
Private Banker / Relationship Manager	Own the client relationship end to end — understand their wealth, their family, their business, and coordinate every specialist around them. Ultimately a revenue-owning role.	You want commercial ownership and are genuinely interested in people's lives, not just markets.
Investment Counsellor / Advisor	Translate the house investment view into a specific portfolio for a specific client, and defend it when markets fall. The bridge between the investment engine and the client.	You want markets exposure but with a named human on the other side of the conversation.
Discretionary Portfolio Manager	Actually manage the money — asset allocation, manager and security selection, risk. This is the £55.8bn of AUM.	You want to be judged on investment decisions rather than relationships.
Wealth Planner	Tax, trusts, succession, estate and business-exit planning. Long-horizon, technical, and the piece clients value most in practice.	You like technical problem-solving with a legal and tax edge.
Credit & Lending Structuring	Structure bespoke lending against portfolios, property and unlisted holdings. Barclays' balance sheet is a differentiator; this is the team that deploys it.	You want credit analysis with genuinely non-standard cases.
Product, COO & Business Management	Build the platform — Direct Investing, the app, digital advice, the Singapore booking centre. Where the "tech spend up 75%" is actually being spent.	You want to shape how advice scales rather than deliver it one client at a time.

The case for joining this division

- **It is the best-returning business in Barclays** — 26.3% RoTE in FY2025, 26.1% in H1 2026, against a target of "greater than 25%". You are not joining a problem child.
- **It is small enough that you are visible.** Around 1,300 people in the private bank against 91,065 across the group. On an investment banking analyst class you are one of hundreds; here you are not.
- **It is actively hiring into a stated plan** — up to 100 advisers funded in the 2026 cost base. Growth divisions promote faster than mature ones.
- **The strategic priority is real and expensive.** Technology spend up more than 75%; a £2.7bn bid tabled for Evelyn Partners. Firms do not bid billions on businesses they intend to run down.
- **The skills compound rather than expire.** A private banker's value is a book of relationships and technical judgement built over decades — it grows with age, unlike the stamina-driven early years of an investment banking career.

- **It sits at the intersection of everything.** To serve one entrepreneur well you touch the corporate bank, the investment bank, credit, tax and markets. Few seats give you that view of a universal bank.

THE CASE AGAINST — KNOW IT, AND BE READY FOR IT

It is slower. Relationships are built over years. If you want to point at a completed transaction after eight weeks, this is the wrong division.

Exit options are narrower than investment banking. There is no conventional private equity path out of wealth management; the route is to other wealth managers, to a family office, or to independence.

Costs are under pressure. A 73% cost:income ratio with costs growing 11% against 2% income growth will not be tolerated indefinitely. The investment has to pay off.

Scale is a live disadvantage. NatWest just bought its way past Barclays on UK AUM. The organic strategy has to work.

Ten numbers to have ready

Fact	Figure
Divisional income and its share of the group	£1,380m — 4.8% of Barclays' FY2025 income
RoTE, and its rank in the group	26.3% FY2025 — highest of the five divisions
Capital consumed	£8.0bn of RWAs — just 2.2% of the group
The target	RoTE >25% in both 2026 and 2028
Assets under management	£55.8bn (June 2026), from £52.9bn at end-2025
Client assets & liabilities	£227.6bn , up from £208.9bn
The revenue split	58% net interest income, 42% fees
The target market	~4 million Barclays UK customers with £250k–£3m
The investment being made	100 advisers ; tech spend up >75%
The competitive event of the year	NatWest bought Evelyn for £2.7bn; Barclays bid and lost

Six questions to ask on 14 September

1. “Roughly 58% of the division's income is net interest income rather than fees. As rates come down, how hard is it to grow the fee side fast enough to replace it?” — *shows you understand the revenue model, not just the brand.*
2. “Net new AUM was £1.8bn in the first half, a little below last year, while headline AUM rose on market moves. What are you doing to accelerate genuinely new money?” — *this is the metric insiders actually watch.*
3. “NatWest bought Evelyn and Barclays is growing organically. Does that change the pace you have to move at with the Premier Wealth Management proposition?” — *current, sharp, and impossible to have got from a careers page.*
4. “Around four million Barclays UK customers sit in the £250k–£3m band. What is the actual bottleneck in converting them — is it advisers, technology, or client willingness?” — *demonstrates you understand the growth plan's mechanics.*

5. "The division straddles the ring-fence, with UK wealth inside and international outside. How does that shape what you can offer a client with money in two countries?" — *almost nobody knows this.*
6. "How much of the work is actually investment judgement versus planning, tax and structuring? I want to understand what the job is day to day." — *honest, useful to you, and shows you are choosing deliberately.*

YOUR ANSWER TO "WHY WEALTH MANAGEMENT, AND WHY BARCLAYS?"

"Wealth management is the best-returning business inside Barclays — 26% return on tangible equity on about 2% of the group's capital — and it's the one they've chosen to invest in, with a hundred new advisers and technology spend up more than 75%. What makes Barclays' version interesting to me specifically is the funnel: roughly four million existing Barclays UK customers have between £250,000 and £3 million to invest, so unlike an independent, Barclays doesn't have to find its clients. It also has a bulge-bracket investment bank, so it's in the room when a founder actually sells their company. I like that it's a business where your value compounds over a career rather than burning out early — and I'd rather join while they're still building it than after it's finished."

ONE THING TO GET RIGHT

Do not say "assets under management" when you mean total client assets. Barclays has **£55.8bn of AUM**, **£140.6bn of invested assets** (AUM plus assets under supervision), and **£227.6bn of client assets and liabilities** (which adds deposits and lending). Using the right one for the right point is the clearest possible signal that you read the results rather than a summary of them.

PART ELEVEN

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Compiled 23 August 2026 for the Barclays Insight Day × SEO London, 14 September 2026. Figures are as reported by the companies concerned. Asset measures are not directly comparable across firms — AUM, invested assets and total client assets mean different things, and the measure used is named in each case. Nothing in this document is investment advice.